

Green Valley Community Hospital

Outpatient Desk

Appointments and Outpatient Policy

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Purpose

This policy explains how outpatient appointments are booked, confirmed, rescheduled, and cancelled at Green Valley Community Hospital. It is administrative in nature and does not provide medical advice.

The policy is intended to help outpatients plan their visits with confidence, and to help the outpatient desk manage the daily appointment schedule fairly for all patients.

Scope

This policy applies to all patients booking or attending outpatient appointments at Green Valley Community Hospital.

It does not apply to inpatient admissions, which are covered separately by the Admission and Registration Policy, or to emergency visits, which do not require a booked appointment.

Appointment Booking

Appointments can be requested through the outpatient desk, either in person, by phone during desk hours, or, where available, through the hospital's online appointment request form. The outpatient desk operates from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Saturday.

New Appointments

Patients booking an appointment for the first time should provide their name, contact details, and a general reason for the visit. The outpatient desk will confirm the earliest available appointment slot and provide an appointment reference.

Returning Appointments

Returning patients can book a follow-up appointment using their existing patient reference number, which helps the outpatient desk quickly locate their basic details and previous visit history.

Appointment Confirmation

Patients should confirm appointment details before the visit, including the date, time, and department. Confirmation messages are sent by phone or email, where contact details are available, usually one day before the scheduled appointment.

Outpatient Registration

On the day of the appointment, patients should check in at the outpatient desk at least 15 minutes before their scheduled time. Outpatient registration confirms the patient's identity and appointment details before directing them to the waiting area.

Rescheduling

Patients who cannot attend should contact the outpatient desk to reschedule. Rescheduling requests are handled on a first-come, first-served basis, and patients are encouraged to reschedule as early as possible to secure a convenient new slot.

How to Reschedule

- 1 Contact the outpatient desk by phone or in person.
- 2 Provide the original appointment reference number.
- 3 Choose a new available date and time from the options offered.
- 4 Receive a new appointment confirmation.

Cancellation

Appointments can be cancelled by contacting the outpatient desk. Patients are encouraged to cancel as early as possible if they know they cannot attend, so the time slot can be offered to another patient.

Late Arrival

Patients arriving significantly late may need to request a new appointment slot, since later appointments may already be scheduled for other patients. The outpatient desk will do its best to fit in a patient who arrives only a few minutes late, depending on how busy the schedule is that day.

Arrival Situation	Typical Outcome
A few minutes late	Usually seen as originally scheduled, subject to availability
Significantly late	May be asked to reschedule for a later time or another day
Unable to attend at all	Should contact the outpatient desk to cancel or reschedule

Waiting Area

Patients are asked to wait in the outpatient waiting area after checking in. Names or appointment numbers are called in order, though actual wait times can vary depending on how the day's schedule is progressing.

Appointment Records

The outpatient desk keeps a record of appointment history for each patient, including booked, completed, rescheduled, and cancelled appointments. Patients can ask the outpatient desk for a summary of their appointment history if needed.

Missed Appointments

If a patient misses an appointment without contacting the outpatient desk in advance, the appointment is recorded as missed, and the patient will need to book a new appointment through the usual booking process. Patients who miss appointments frequently may be asked to confirm appointments a little further in advance for future bookings.

A missed appointment can also affect scheduling for other patients, since the reserved time slot could otherwise have been offered to someone on a waiting list. For this reason, even a short notice cancellation is more helpful than no notice at all.

Contacting the Outpatient Desk

Patients can reach the outpatient desk by phone during desk hours, in person at the outpatient reception area, or through the online appointment request form where available. For urgent same-day changes, calling the outpatient desk directly is usually the fastest option.

Patients who are unsure which department to book an appointment with can describe their general concern to the outpatient desk, and staff will help direct the request to the appropriate department for scheduling.

Responsibilities

The Outpatient Desk is responsible for booking, confirming, and recording appointments. Patients are responsible for attending on time or contacting the outpatient desk promptly if they need to reschedule or cancel.

Both the Outpatient Desk and the patient benefit from clear communication: the desk aims to send timely confirmations, and patients are encouraged to update their contact details if these ever change, so confirmations reach them reliably.

Exceptions

In situations where a patient's condition changes and an earlier appointment is needed, the outpatient desk will try to accommodate an earlier slot where possible, based on availability.

Patients with a recurring series of follow-up appointments, such as regular check-ins for an ongoing administrative or billing matter, can ask the outpatient desk about booking several appointments in advance to simplify future scheduling.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I reschedule an outpatient appointment?

A: Contact the outpatient desk with your original appointment reference number and choose a new available date and time.

Q: What happens if a patient misses an appointment?

A: The appointment is recorded as missed, and the patient will need to book a new appointment through the usual booking process.

Q: How early should I arrive for my appointment?

A: Patients should check in at the outpatient desk at least 15 minutes before their scheduled appointment time.

Q: What are the outpatient desk hours?

A: The outpatient desk operates from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Saturday.

Q: Can I book a follow-up appointment using my patient reference number?

A: Yes. Returning patients can use their existing patient reference number to book a follow-up appointment more quickly.

Q: What happens if I arrive significantly late?

A: You may need to request a new appointment slot, depending on how busy the schedule is that day.

Contact Information

For general questions about this policy, please contact the Administrative Services Desk.

Contact Point	Details
Administrative Services Desk	+1-555-010-2400
General Email	info@greenvalleyhospital.example
Hospital Address	25 Green Valley Road, Riverside District, New Harmony
Desk Hours	Monday to Saturday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM